

DISCOVERY DAY 2026

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3-4 June 2026 | Sofia, Capital Fort

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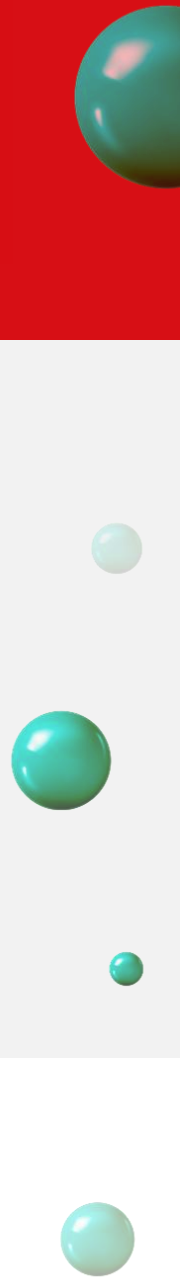


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DISCOVERY
DAY **2026**



Power BI Beyond the Read-only Writebacks And Automation With Fabric User Data Functions

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Moving from **looking** at data to **acting**
on data without leaving the Power BI
using Fabric User Data Functions

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DHYAN RATHORE

Fabric Enablement Lead @ **Autoliv**



dhyans



The Bulgarian Data Community Conference

THANK YOU, PARTNERS!

DISCOVERY
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Host and Main Community Event Sponsor



The organizations whose support made this event possible



Making the day more enjoyable and delicious



Ensuring accommodation for speakers and guests

Those who helped us spread the word and supported us along the way



Bringing extra excitement and surprises

Agenda - Power BI Beyond the Read-only

- **Why**
- **What**
- **How**
- **Demos**

Historically, Power BI has been a “**look
but don't touch**” tool

Developers have been “**hacking**” Power
BI to do things

Writebacks

Sending data from a Power BI report back into a data source. For adding, editing or deleting the data.

Automation

Calling external APIs to automate actions or workflows from a Power BI report

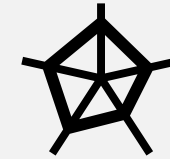
The story so far



Power Apps



Power Automate

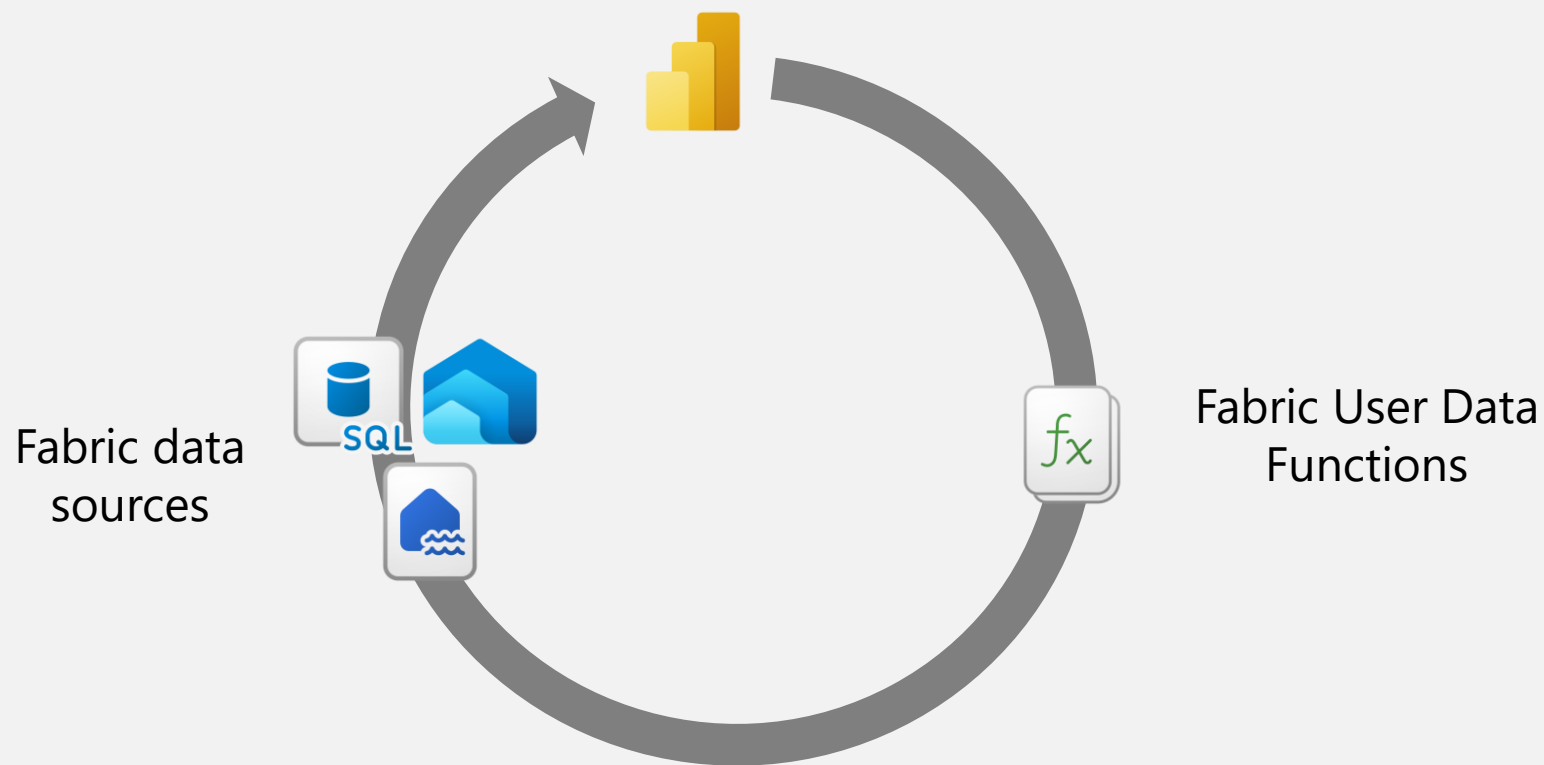


Third-party Visuals

- Requires premium/user-based licensing
- Slow to load & high end-to-end latency
- Complex architecture
- Disconnected data source and targeted data storage
- Administrative overhead & separate governance

The Paradigm Shift

Translytical Task Flows in Power BI



User Data Functions (UDFs)

- Reusable Python functions that can be called from Fabric and external applications via REST endpoints.
- Supported Fabric data sources
 - SQL databases: Read and write
 - Warehouses: Read and write
 - Lakehouses: Read and write files, read-only to SQL analytics endpoints
 - Mirrored databases*: Read-only

Scenarios

- Adding, updating & deleting data
- Data annotation and quality management
- Approval workflows
- Calling external APIs
- Workflow automation
- AI-assisted data enrichment

Building a Translytical Task Flow: Step-by-Step

Storing your data in a Fabric data source*

Developing a User Data Function to handle the action

Creating a Power BI semantic model to use this data

Building a Power BI report with interactive elements to capture the user's input and call the function



Translytical Flows - Fundamentals

Input Controls for Parameters: **Slicers**



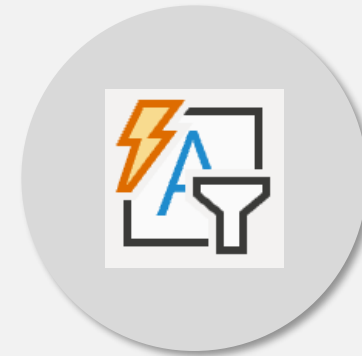
Button Slicer

- Must be linked to a data field
- Remove all visual interactions to use only as an input control



List Slicer

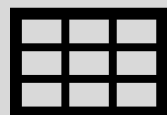
- Must be linked to a data field
- Remove all visual interactions to use only as an input control



Input Slicer

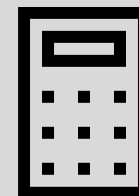
- Can be used purely as an input control
- Only link to a data field if you need to use it for filtering data

Input Controls for Parameters: Data Fields & Measures



Data Fields

- Use `SELECTEDVALUE()` in a measure to pass a data field as parameter



Measures

- Can be passed directly as a parameter



Translytical Flows - Writeback

Advanced Features

- Access invocation metadata about who called your function and how
- Handle custom error scenarios with structured error responses
- Connect to Azure Key Vault to retrieve secrets
- Integrate with Fabric variable libraries for centralized configuration and lifecycle management
- Add public Python libraries from PyPI or custom private libraries

Limitations

- Functions are editable by the owner only
- "Manage connections" only supports Fabric data sources
- Accessing UDFs using a service principal is not supported
- Power BI reports can't use a parameter to connect to an UDF

Sample Translytical Flows

- <https://gist.github.com/Sujata994/c354ec8d0821e875e45c86f2bd1d5cc8>
- https://community.fabric.microsoft.com/t5/Translytical-Task-Flow-Gallery/bd-p/pbi_translyticalgallery

Sujata994 / Example User data functions.md Secret

Last active 15 hours ago

<> Code Revisions 19 Stars 25 Forks 10 Embed <script src="https://g" Download ZIP

Example User data functions for Translytical task flows

Example User data functions.md Raw

Translytical task flows examples

Example User data functions

Check out the below example [User data functions](#) for the following Translytical task flow demo scenarios:

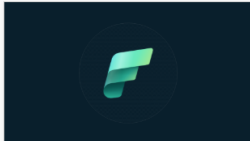
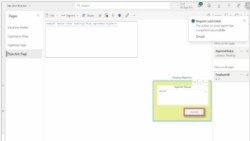
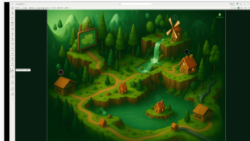
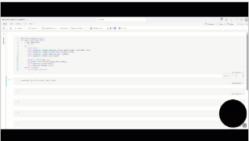
- **Modify data record(s)**
 - [Update Discount](#): Set a new discount value
- **Data annotation**
 - [Add Annotation](#): Add a new datapoint annotation
 - [Edit Annotation](#): Update an existing annotation
 - [Delete Annotation](#): Delete a specific annotation
- **Augment data on the fly**
 - [Get Contact Info](#): Get latest contact info data for a registered partner company
- **Dynamic notifications**
 - [Dynamic Marketing Email](#): For accepted offers send a dynamic marketing email to company's point of contact
- **Approval workflows**
 - [Request Discount](#): Request for an admin to approve a discount
 - [Approve Discount](#): Admin can apply the discount
- **Custom AI integration**
 - [AI Suggestions](#): AI suggestions for collab proposals

Power BI forums > Galleries

Translytical Task Flow Gallery

Recently Posted Featured Top Kudos All posts

Submit to gallery Options

 Intelliventra - Smart Event Management Application Prachinain_2025 14	 Accounting Process Flow Automation by Translytical Flow Julit_Insight 3	 Vacation Tracker NandanHegde Featured 54	 Wallet Watch Analytics: Expense Tracker Santhanalakshmi Featured 21
 Dynamic Power BI Experiences Alex87 35	 Decrypting data on the fly jwshock 1	 Add Commentary to Financial Reports using Translytical michaelolafusi 10	 IoT Defect Tracking and Resolution from PBI report Mauro89 6

Recap



**Writebacks and
Automation**



**Translytical
Flows**



**User Data
Functions**



Demos

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Get the slides...



<https://github.com/DhyanRathore/Presentations>

Thank YOU!

We'd love to hear your thoughts!

Please take a minute to complete
short feedback survey.



<https://tinyurl.com/dday2026-rathore>

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Join the QUIZ

DISCOVERY
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Show your knowledge, score points, and
compete for **BIG PRIZES!**

The quiz takes place during the **After Party**

Join from your phone
Fast, fun, and interactive

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